R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · EDITING DATA · LESSON 2

02 Select columns by position with [,]

Pick columns by their number with square brackets, and use ranges like 6:10.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Read the [rows, columns] pattern
- Select columns by number with c()
- Use a colon for a range of columns

The R code in this lesson

```
# [rows, columns]: empty rows = all rows
Demographic_1 <- Dataset[, c(2, 3, 4)]

# A colon makes a range: 6:10 means 6, 7, 8, 9, 10
Main <- Dataset[, c(2, 3, 6:10)]

View(Main)

# Count values in a column
table(Demographic$`Sex of household head`)
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Typing long column names can be tiring. In this lesson, you will learn a shortcut: selecting columns by their position number, with square brackets. You will also learn the colon, which picks a whole range at once. Let's try it.

0:00 Here is the dataset in View. Column one is Single Response, column two is Province Name, three is Sex of household head, and four is Marital Status.

0:20 Square brackets work like an address: first the rows, then a comma, then the columns. If we leave the rows empty, R takes all the rows.

0:35 So: Demographic underscore one, arrow, Dataset, open square bracket, comma, c, two, three, four, close bracket.

0:55 Run it, and the new table has three hundred fifty two rows, and three columns: province, sex, and marital status. The same result as select, with much less typing.

1:15 Now a second table, called Main. Inside c, I write two, three, and then six, colon, ten.

1:35 The colon means: from six to ten. So we get columns six, seven, eight, nine, and ten, without typing each one.

1:50 Run it. Main has seven columns. Open it, and there they are: province, sex, the land questions, and the wage labor answers.

2:30 A small warning: positions change if columns are added or removed. Names are safer for scripts you will reuse. Positions are great for quick looks.

2:50 Next, a new note: to bring changes in a single or more values or cells. Before we change anything, I use table to count the values in the Sex of household head column. Nice work!